

BEYOND THE KINGDOM

Episode #0004

Air Date: Thursday, January 6, 2005

Prod. #BTK-0004

Story Day: Thursday, January 6, 2005 (7:14 AM - 11:52 PM
EST)

Teleplay by the Beyond the Kingdom Writers' Room
Final Shooting Script

CAST OF CHARACTERS – EPISODE #0004

(ages as of Thursday, January 6, 2005)

THE DONOHUES: SIMONE DONOHUE (94) · VICTOR DONOHUE (68) · JOAN DONOHUE (66)

THE OLSONS: MARTIN OLSON (23) · MALLORY OLSON (19)

THE BULLOCKS: ROBERT BULLOCK (45) · NATASHA DONOHUE BULLOCK (43) · CHIEF ELXA BULLOCK JACKSON (24) · DET. JEREMY JACKSON (24) · MARC-ANTHONY BULLOCK (23) · GRACE BULLOCK (20)

THE SMILLEYS: ODESSA SMILLEY (84) · LUCIUS SMILLEY (55) · VIVIENNE SMILLEY (49) · DELPHINE SMILLEY-ASHE (25) · ESTHER SMILLEY (22) · EMMA SMILLEY (2) · VICTORIA SMILLEY (2)

THE CIRCLE: AMOND BAKER (22) · ARIANNA CUMMINGS (22) · HARMONY DIVINE (22) · LYRIC SOLACE BAKER (2)

THE SEVEN: TOBIAS OKAFOR (24) · RASHAD "SAINT" MAYFIELD (23)

RECURRING: CELESTE VAUGHN (24) · CAMILLE RHODES (38) · SILAS MERRIWEATHER (57) · LORETTA DIVINE (49) · CALVIN DIVINE (51) · DR. CURTIS BAKER (50) · GLORIA BAKER (48) · DR. YVETTE CUMMINGS (51) · WINSTON FAIRLEY (62) · RUBY "NANA RUBY" TOLLIVER (66) · BEATRIX "NANNY BEA" PENNINGTON (43)

SUPPORTING: KIARA BAKER (15)

DAY PLAYERS: ASSISTANT DA PRESTON · OTIS · NURSE TONYA · KEYONNA (7) · DEANDRE (9) · EARL "BIG E" TUGGLE (51) · A GLOVED MAN · WAITRESS

MENTIONED, NOT SEEN: Darnell "Dee" Divine · Alvin Donohue (Miami) · Detective R. Sams · Stanley (Gloria's lawyer) · Mama Dee (by phone with Silas, heard only on his end)

FADE IN:

TEASER

**1 INT. HARMONY'S TOWNHOUSE — LINDBERGH — KITCHEN —
MORNING**

Thursday, January 6, 2005 — 7:14 AM EST

Gray winter light through a small window over the sink.
Coffee brewing in a secondhand Mr. Coffee.

HARMONY DIVINE (22) stands at the kitchen table in a
thrift-store navy suit, ironing a stack of papers flat
with the side of her hand. She's been up since five.

On the table is a thick, battered three-ring BINDER,
bristling with colored tabs and labeled on the spine in
marker: "DEE."

LYRIC (2) sits in a booster seat eating Cheerios one at a
time, very seriously.

The back door opens without a knock. LORETTA DIVINE (49),
who looks thirty-nine, comes in wearing her Grady Memorial
ER scrubs under a wool coat. She's just come off a
twelve-hour night shift. She's small, fierce, and funny,
and she stopped trusting the police a long time ago.

LORETTA

You ate?

HARMONY

I'm not hungry.

LORETTA

That's not what I asked.

(kissing Lyric's head)
Morning, sugar.

LYRIC

Grandma, I'm eating circles.

LORETTA

I see that. You eat all the
circles, you'll grow up round.

Loretta pours herself coffee and looks at the binder.

LORETTA (CONT'D)

You're taking the whole thing?

HARMONY

Every page. Every flyer. Every detective's card who never called me back. The printout from the tip line. The map.

LORETTA

Baby, it's four inches thick.

HARMONY

It's three years thick, Mama.

Loretta sets down her coffee. She touches the binder's cover, gently, where someone has taped a wallet-sized photo of a smiling young man in a barber's smock.

LORETTA

(quietly)

I haven't been downtown about your brother since the second detective. You remember him? Detective Sams?

HARMONY

He said Dee probably "went to Miami with a girl."

LORETTA

(tight)

Dee wouldn't go to Miami without telling me what he was eating for breakfast. Every day of his life he called me. Every day.

(beat)

I stopped believing in police the day that man smiled at me.

HARMONY

She's not police, Mama. She's the District Attorney.

LORETTA

She's a baby. She's your age.

HARMONY

She's the youngest DA in Georgia history. She's reopening cold cases. She said, "Come see me."

(beat)

She looked me in the eye.

Loretta studies her daughter's face: the hope in it, so fragile it could break on a word.

LORETTA

All right.

(picking up her coffee)

Then I'm coming with you.

HARMONY

You just worked twelve hours.

LORETTA

I've worked twelve hours for
strangers every night for twenty
years. I can sit in a chair for
my own son.

Harmony hugs her mother hard.

Lyric holds up a single Cheerio to them both, generous.

LYRIC

Circle?

CUT TO:

**2 INT. FULTON COUNTY COURTHOUSE – DISTRICT ATTORNEY'S
OFFICE – MORNING**

Thursday, January 6, 2005 – 7:41 AM EST

The office is dark except for the desk lamp. The building
is quiet. It's too early for anyone else.

DISTRICT ATTORNEY ARIANNA CUMMINGS (22) sits at her desk
in a charcoal suit with her coat still on. She hasn't
touched her coffee.

She opens the bottom drawer, moves aside the box of
tissues, and lifts out the thin, dusty accordion file.

MP-2002-0014. DIVINE, DARNELL M.

She sets it on the blotter. She looks at it for a long
moment.

Then, for the first time, she opens it.

Inside: a missing-person report, two pages. A handwritten
detective's note, one page. And clipped to the front, a
PHOTOGRAPH: DARNELL "DEE" DIVINE (22 at the time),
grinning at the camera, holding up a pair of clippers like
a trophy, in the barbershop chair on Cascade Road.

Arianna looks at his face. Her breathing changes.

INSERT – THE REPORT: "Subject last seen approx. 0145 hrs, 01/01/02, leaving private residence, 3100 block Northside Dr. NW, on foot. Destination: unknown. No vehicle. No witnesses. Family states subject 'never misses a call.' Det. R. Sams. Status: INACTIVE – no leads."

She reads the words "on foot" twice.

She reaches for her coffee, then stops, because her hand is shaking too badly to lift it.

She presses both palms flat on the desk and closes her eyes. She breathes. Four counts in. Four counts out. It's a technique someone taught her. It doesn't work.

She opens her eyes and looks at the clock: 7:43.

ARIANNA
(to the empty room,
rehearsing, barely
audible)
"Mrs. Divine. Thank you for
coming. I've reviewed your son's
file..."

Her voice cracks on "son."

She stops. She closes the file.

SMASH CUT TO:

MAIN TITLES – "KINGDOM"

ACT ONE**3 INT. RAVENHURST — THE MORNING ROOM — MORNING**

Thursday, January 6, 2005 — 8:12 AM EST

A sunny breakfast room with French windows onto the frozen formal garden. Silver chafing dishes. Two tables: one for the adults, and a small one where EMMA and VICTORIA eat oatmeal with Bea hovering.

LUCIUS sits at the head of the table in a dove-gray suit, reading the Atlanta Sentinel. ODESSA, in a silk caftan, butters a croissant. ESTHER, dressed for the office in cream, sips black coffee and reads a contract.

Lucius turns a page. He stops. He reads.

INSERT — THE SENTINEL, "BEHIND THE GATES": "...a black Maybach bearing a certain Chicago family's vanity plate pulled up to the Crown Gate. The rear window lowered. My source saw scarlet silk... And then the car turned around."

He folds the paper very slowly and sets it beside his plate.

LUCIUS

You went to the gate.

Esther doesn't look up from her contract.

ESTHER

And I left.

LUCIUS

In the red dress. The whole city's reading about it over their grits.

ESTHER

The whole city is reading that a Smilley declined a Donohue invitation at the door. I'd call that a good headline.

LUCIUS

Bernadette Sinclair called it "two visits to one gate in three days." She said she's "been to a few weddings."

ODESSA
(delighted, not looking
up)
Bernadette always did have a
gift.

LUCIUS
Mother, don't encourage her.

ODESSA
I don't need to. She's already
encouraged.

Lucius turns to Esther. His voice drops.

LUCIUS
Esther. Look at me.

She sets down the contract and looks at him.

LUCIUS (CONT'D)
Whatever game you're playing with
that family, and I know you're
playing one, you're too smart not
to be, understand this. Victor
Donohue watches everything. His
mother watches everything he
misses. They will read you like a
ledger.
(beat)
Stay away from them.

ESTHER
(evenly)
That's been the plan, Daddy. For
a very long time.

Something in the way she says it makes Odessa look up.

Lucius reaches for his coffee cup. His right hand TREMBLES
as he lifts it, and coffee sloshes over the rim onto the
saucer.

He sets it down fast and puts his hand in his lap.

Esther saw it. So did Odessa. Neither says a word.

LUCIUS
(rising, too briskly)
I have a call with Dubai.

He goes. Esther looks at the spilled coffee on the saucer.

ODESSA
(quietly)
He's been doing that since
October.

ESTHER
(turning, sharp)
You've seen it?

ODESSA
Baby, I've been watching men hide
things since Roosevelt. Your
father's hiding a tremor. Your
mother's hiding the fact that she
knows.
(she takes a delicate
bite of croissant)
And you're hiding something too.
Aren't you?

At the children's table, Victoria throws her head back and
laughs at something Bea has said: a big, whole-body laugh.

Esther doesn't look at her daughter. She picks up her
contract.

ESTHER
I have a board meeting to
prepare, Grandma.

ODESSA
(sipping her tea)
Mm-hm.

CUT TO:

**4 INT. MERRIWEATHER & SONS FUNERAL HOME – SILAS'S OFFICE
– MORNING**

Thursday, January 6, 2005 – 8:49 AM EST

A private office behind the parlor: a rolltop desk, a
safe, a photograph of Silas's father shaking hands with a
young Martin Luther King Jr., and a window onto Ralph
David Abernathy Boulevard.

SILAS MERRIWEATHER stands at the window with a phone to
his ear. Across the boulevard, a gray unmarked Crown
Victoria sits at the curb with two plainclothes officers
inside.

Behind him, OTIS sets down a tray with two paper cups of
coffee and a bag of doughnuts.

SILAS
(into phone)
-I know, Dolores. I know.

He looks at his gold pocket watch. It's a lot like the one Marc now carries, but silver.

SILAS (CONT'D)
(into phone)
Two days, Dolores.
(listening)
Friday night. That's what I said
and that's what I meant. Not
Saturday morning, when four
hundred people are walking into
Greater Cascade. Friday night.
(beat)
And Dolores, the pie was very
good.
(beat, a small smile)
Don't let it go to your head.

He hangs up. He turns to Otis.

OTIS
The police are still out there.
Since yesterday morning.

SILAS
I know.

OTIS
You want me to move them?

SILAS
I want you to take them coffee.

OTIS
(blinking)
Coffee?

SILAS
(picking up the tray,
handing it to him)
And the doughnuts. Cream-filled.
Those boys have been sitting in a
cold car outside a funeral home
for twenty-four hours. That's not
surveillance, Otis. That's a
vigil.
(beat)
And when they thank you, you tell
them Silas Merriweather has

nothing to hide, and nobody to
fear, except whoever killed
Lamar.

Otis takes the tray and goes, shaking his head.

Silas turns back to the window and watches his lieutenant
cross the boulevard with coffee and doughnuts for the
police.

SILAS (CONT'D)
(to himself)
Whoever you are...
(beat)
...you picked the wrong deacon.

CUT TO:

**5 INT. FULTON COUNTY COURTHOUSE – DISTRICT ATTORNEY'S
OFFICE – DAY**

Thursday, January 6, 2005 – 10:02 AM EST

Full daylight now. The office looks official, composed,
safe. The Divine file is not on the desk.

Arianna stands as Preston shows in Harmony and Loretta.
She's composed, professional, and warm. She is also
clutching a pen under the desk hard enough to crack it.

ARIANNA
Ms. Divine. Mrs. Divine. Thank
you for coming. Please, sit.

HARMONY
(sitting, clutching the
binder)
Thank you for seeing us. You
didn't have to.

ARIANNA
Yes. I did.

LORETTA
(not sitting yet,
studying Arianna)
You're younger in person.

ARIANNA
(a small smile)
I get that a lot, Mrs. Divine.

LORETTA
You're younger than my son.
(beat)
Than my son would be.

That lands. Loretta sits.

HARMONY
(opening the binder)
I brought everything. I know it's
a lot. It's every flyer, every
tip, every card from every
detective. This is the map of
where the tips came from. The red
pins are—

ARIANNA
(gently)
Harmony.

Harmony stops.

ARIANNA (CONT'D)
I've read the file.

LORETTA
(sharp)
What file?

ARIANNA
Your son's. The official one.
Missing-person report
MP-2002-0014. It was in a closet
with six hundred and forty other
cases that nobody had touched in
two years.
(beat)
I took it out. I read it this
morning.

LORETTA
And what does it say?

Arianna holds her gaze.

ARIANNA
It says a detective named Sams
wrote "no leads" after nine days.

LORETTA
(bitter)
Nine days.

ARIANNA

It says your son left a party on
Northside Drive at about one
forty-five in the morning. On
foot. Alone. No car.

(beat)

And it says you told the
detective that he never missed a
call.

Loretta's jaw tightens. Her eyes fill, and she refuses to
let them spill.

LORETTA

He didn't. Not once in twenty-two
years.

HARMONY

(pushing a yellow flyer
across the desk)

Please.

(her voice breaking)

Everybody else stopped looking.

Arianna looks down at the flyer. Dee's face, grinning,
holding his clippers.

For a long moment she doesn't speak.

Under the desk, the pen in her hand SNAPS. Ink bleeds onto
her palm. She doesn't look down.

ARIANNA

(very quietly)

I won't stop.

HARMONY

You promise?

ARIANNA

(meeting her eyes)

I promise.

Harmony bursts into tears, the kind of crying that happens
when you've held something up by yourself for three years
and someone finally takes one end. Loretta puts an arm
around her daughter, but her own eyes stay on Arianna,
shrewd.

LORETTA

What happens now?

ARIANNA

(steady, professional,
a lifeline)

Your son's case is being
reassigned to my new cold case
unit. Four investigators start
Monday. I'll put my best one on
it personally. You'll get a call
from my office every two weeks
whether there's news or not. You
will never again have to wonder
whether anybody is looking.

LORETTA

(beat)

And if they find him?

The question hangs in the air.

ARIANNA

(barely)

Then you'll know.

Loretta studies her a long moment. Then she nods, once.

LORETTA

Thank you, Madam District
Attorney.

ARIANNA

Arianna.

LORETTA

(rising)

Madam District Attorney.

(beat)

I'll call you Arianna when you
bring my baby home.

Harmony stands, wiping her face, holding out her hand
across the desk.

HARMONY

Thank you. Thank you so much.

Arianna starts to reach out, then realizes her palm is
covered in blue ink. She hesitates.

ARIANNA

I'm sorry. I broke a pen.

HARMONY
(laughing through
tears, taking her
ink-stained hand
anyway, both hands)
I don't care.

She squeezes. Then Preston shows them out.

The door closes.

Arianna stands alone in her office, looking down at her
blue-stained palm.

She walks very carefully to her private bathroom, closes
the door, and turns on the faucet as hard as it will go.

The water runs and runs.

FADE OUT.

ACT TWO**6 INT. FULTON COUNTY COURTHOUSE – DISTRICT ATTORNEY'S OFFICE – DAY**

Thursday, January 6, 2005 – 10:53 AM EST

Arianna, composed again, sits at her desk writing a memo. Her right palm is scrubbed pink, with a faint blue shadow still in the creases.

Preston knocks and leans in.

PRESTON

Madam DA, Chief Jackson is here.
She doesn't have an appointment.

ARIANNA

(not looking up)

She never does. Send her in.

CHIEF ELXA JACKSON (24) enters in uniform with a slim folder. She doesn't sit.

ELXA

I need a subpoena.

ARIANNA

Good morning to you too, Chief.

ELXA

Good morning. I need a subpoena.

ARIANNA

For?

ELXA

(setting the folder
down)

Personal cell phone records. My
command staff. Monday, January
third, nine p.m. to midnight.

Arianna opens the folder and reads the one-page request. She reads it twice.

ARIANNA

Your own deputies.

ELXA

Somebody on my staff leaked the coin to WBKG forty minutes before it aired. That's evidence in an active homicide.

ARIANNA

Do you know who?

ELXA

I have a strong suspicion.

ARIANNA

Based on what?

Elxa hesitates. It's a fraction of a second, but Arianna catches it.

ELXA

Based on a source.

ARIANNA

What source?

ELXA

A confidential one.

ARIANNA

(setting the folder down)

Elxa. You want me to sign a subpoena for the private phone records of five senior police officers, including a deputy chief who has friends on the City Council, on the word of a source you won't name, for a leak that hasn't been shown to compromise the investigation.

(beat)

Any judge in this building will laugh me out of chambers. And Warren Hughes will have it in the Sentinel by dinner. "Nepotism Chief Spies on Her Own Command."

ELXA

(frustrated)

So I just let him do it?

ARIANNA

No. You go through Internal Affairs. You open a policy investigation. You give him a reason to slip.

(beat)

You're a detective. Set a trap.

Elxa looks at her for a long moment. Then something in her face shifts: an idea.

ELXA

(slowly)

A trap.

ARIANNA

A canary. Tell each of them something different and see which version shows up on Channel 8.

Elxa almost smiles.

ELXA

That's devious, Madam DA.

ARIANNA

I'm a prosecutor. It's in the job description.

Elxa picks up her folder. At the door, she pauses and looks back.

ELXA

You look pale.

ARIANNA

(too quickly)

I skipped breakfast.

ELXA

(beat)

You met with the Divine girl this morning. Harmony. I saw her in the lobby with her mother.

Arianna keeps her face perfectly still.

ARIANNA

I did.

ELXA

Missing brother. New Year's 2002.

ARIANNA

Yes.

ELXA

(gently)

Those are the worst ones. The families who don't know.

(beat)

If you need APD on it, anything, it's yours. I'll give you my best.

ARIANNA

(the smallest pause)

Thank you, Chief.

Elxa nods and leaves.

Arianna sits alone. She looks down at the blue shadow in the creases of her palm.

CUT TO:

**7 INT. CHILDREN'S HEALTHCARE OF ATLANTA AT EGLESTON –
PEDIATRIC ONCOLOGY PLAYROOM – DAY**

Thursday, January 6, 2005 – 11:32 AM EST

The bright playroom. The animal murals. A dozen kids on the floor in a semicircle.

Marc sits cross-legged in the center in a navy suit, wearing the same paper crown from Monday, somewhat crumpled now. He holds the picture book open to the final pages.

KEYONNA (7), in her pink headscarf, sits right at the front with her knees pulled up, rapt. DEANDRE (9), in his Falcons jersey, sits beside her.

Marc reads the last pages softly, the monster voice gone: Max sails home across the sea, back through the weeks and the days, to his own room, where his supper is waiting.

The kids are silent. He turns the final page.

MARC

(barely above a
whisper)

"...and it was still hot."

He closes the book.

A moment of perfect silence. Then DeAndre starts clapping. All the kids clap. Nurse Tonya, in the doorway, claps too, wiping her eye with a knuckle.

DEANDRE
That's a good ending.

MARC
It's the best ending.

KEYONNA
Why?

Marc thinks about it seriously. He always takes her questions seriously.

MARC
Because Max went away. He went really far. He was the king of the wild things. He had a crown and everybody did what he said.
(beat)
But at the end of the day, what he wanted was to go home. And when he got home, somebody had saved him dinner.
(beat)
That's the best thing in the world, Keyonna. Not being a king. Having somebody save you dinner.

KEYONNA
(considering this)
My mama saves me dinner.

MARC
Then you're luckier than most kings.

Keyonna smiles, a gap-toothed grin.

KEYONNA
Did you find the mama yet?

MARC
What mama?

KEYONNA
For your basketball team. With subs.

The kids giggle. Marc laughs.

MARC

Not yet.

KEYONNA

(very serious)

You should hurry.

MARC

Why?

KEYONNA

(shrugging, as if it's
obvious)

Because the kids are waiting.

Marc looks at her. Something in that lands harder than it should.

His phone BUZZES in his pocket. Nurse Tonya holds up a hand. He gives her a look, "one second," and glances at the screen.

INSERT – TEXT FROM "ARI": "She came. Her mother came too. I promised. I looked at her mother and I promised, Marc."

The smile stays on Marc's face for the kids. But his eyes go still.

He types with one thumb.

INSERT – TEXT TO "ARI": "I know. Breathe. Tonight."

He puts the phone away. He takes off the paper crown and places it gently on Keyonna's head.

MARC (CONT'D)

You hold onto this for me until
Monday. Guard it with your life.

KEYONNA

(solemnly adjusting it)

I will.

MARC

(standing, brushing off
his suit)

New book Monday. You guys pick.

DEANDRE

Something with DINOSAURS.

KEYONNA

Something with a PRINCESS.

MARC

A dinosaur princess. Got it. I'll
write it myself if I have to.

The kids cheer. He waves and heads for the door.

In the hallway, out of sight of the playroom, he stops,
leans against the wall, and closes his eyes for three
seconds.

Then he walks on.

CUT TO:

**8 INT. SMILLEY TOWER – 71ST FLOOR – ESTHER'S OFFICE –
DAY**

Thursday, January 6, 2005 – 12:36 PM EST

Esther stands at her glass wall with a phone to her ear.
Across Peachtree, Donohue Tower's gold crown shines in the
noon sun. A presentation board sits on an easel behind
her: "SMILLEY ATLANTA – REAL ESTATE STRATEGY 2005."

ESTHER

(into phone)

—she promised?

INTERCUT WITH:

**9 INT. HARMONY'S HONDA CIVIC – PARKED – FULTON COUNTY
COURTHOUSE LOT – CONTINUOUS**

Harmony sits behind the wheel, mascara smudged and
grinning. Loretta, in the passenger seat, is asleep
against the window, her mouth slightly open.

HARMONY

She PROMISED, Esther. She looked
my mama in the eye and said, "I
won't stop." She has four
investigators starting Monday.
She read the file already. Before
we got there. She read it at
seven in the morning.

ESTHER

(smiling)

Harm. That's wonderful.

HARMONY

She broke a pen.

ESTHER

She what?

HARMONY

She was holding a pen under the desk, and it snapped, and she got ink all over her hand. She was so nervous for us. Who does that? What District Attorney cares that much about a barber from Cascade?

On Esther's side, her smile holds, but something in her eyes sharpens, briefly, then smooths over.

ESTHER

(lightly)

She sounds very dedicated.

HARMONY

She's AMAZING. And she's our age. And she's Marc's best friend, did I tell you that? They grew up together in Belmont Crest.

ESTHER

(beat)

No. You didn't tell me that.

HARMONY

Anyway! I'm going to sleep for a week. Mama's already asleep. She's snoring in my car.

LORETTA

(eyes closed)

I don't snore.

HARMONY

(whispering)

She snores.

ESTHER

(laughing)

Go home, Harm.

(beat)

Oh, and Harmony. What are you doing next Tuesday? Nine a.m.?

HARMONY

Nothing. Why?

ESTHER

Wear the navy suit. The good one.
And don't be late.

HARMONY

What? Why? Esther—

ESTHER

(smiling at the
presentation board)
It's a surprise. Bye, Harm.

END INTERCUT.

She hangs up. She looks at the presentation board. Near the bottom, under "PREFERRED BROKER — ALL ATLANTA ACQUISITIONS," is a blank line.

She uncaps a pen and writes, in her precise hand: "Harmony Divine."

Then she stands still for a moment, the pen in her hand, thinking about something else entirely.

ESTHER

(to herself, quietly)
"She broke a pen."

She caps the pen. She picks up her desk phone and dials an extension.

ESTHER (CONT'D)

(into phone)
Crowe. The private investigators
we use in Chicago. The discreet
ones.

(beat)
No, not yet. Just find out
whether they're licensed in
Georgia.

She hangs up and looks at the crown across the street.

CUT TO:

10 INT. THE FLYING BISCUIT CAFÉ — MIDTOWN — DAY
Thursday, January 6, 2005 — 1:07 PM EST

A bustling, funky Midtown breakfast-all-day spot: mismatched chairs, local art, and the smell of biscuits and apple butter.

At a corner table, Celeste Vaughn sits in her on-air blazer, stirring a latte. Across from her is Martin Olson, immaculate in a charcoal suit. He looks out of place here and doesn't seem to mind.

CELESTE

I'll be honest, Mr. Olson. I didn't think you'd call.

MARTIN

Martin, please.

(beat)

You kept my card.

CELESTE

I keep everybody's card. I'm a reporter. I have a shoebox.

MARTIN

And where am I in the shoebox?

CELESTE

(smiling)

Somewhere between a city councilman's mistress and a man who says he was abducted by aliens at Six Flags.

MARTIN

(the faintest smile)

Good company.

The WAITRESS sets down two plates of biscuits. Martin doesn't touch his.

CELESTE

So. You said you read the documents. Which documents?

MARTIN

(pleasantly)

Hypothetically? If someone wanted to understand who in Atlanta might be connected to the Blackwater Syndicate, they wouldn't start with the streets. The streets are loud and they lie.

(beat)

They'd start with the courthouse.

CELESTE

Meaning?

MARTIN

Men who get arrested need lawyers. Men who get arrested for the kinds of things Blackwater is rumored to do need very good lawyers. Very expensive ones.

(beat)

Court records are public, Miss Vaughn. Every defense attorney of record, on every case, for five years. It's just a matter of patience. And counting.

Celeste stops stirring her latte.

CELESTE

You're telling me to look at defense attorneys.

MARTIN

I'm not telling you anything. I'm eating a biscuit.

He picks one up and takes a small, precise bite. He is plainly not enjoying it.

CELESTE

(slowly)

Your uncle is the most famous defense attorney in the South.

MARTIN

(dabbing his mouth with a napkin)

Is he? I hadn't noticed.

Celeste studies him for a long moment: the perfect suit, the careful hands, the eyes that give nothing away.

CELESTE

Why would you point me at your own family?

MARTIN

(setting down the napkin)

I'm not pointing you at anyone. I'm pointing you at the truth.

(beat)

If the truth happens to live in my family, then my family has a problem, and I'd rather know about it before the Chief of

Police does.

CELESTE
Your cousin.

MARTIN
My cousin.

CELESTE
(a long beat)
I'm dating Marc-Anthony, you
know.

MARTIN
(standing, dropping two
twenties on the table)
I know.
(buttoning his jacket)
That's why you're the only
reporter in Atlanta who'll be
believed.

He leaves. Celeste sits alone with two plates of biscuits.

She takes out a small reporter's notebook and writes one
word: "COURTHOUSE."

She underlines it twice.

FADE OUT.

ACT THREE

11 INT. BSI TOWER — MARC'S OFFICE — 58TH FLOOR — DAY
Thursday, January 6, 2005 — 1:34 PM EST

The wall of monitors. Marc sits at his desk with the new Patek on his wrist and Alexander's pocket watch lying open on the desk beside his keyboard, ticking.

On his laptop screen, frozen: the gate-camera image of Esther in scarlet, leaning toward the guardhouse.

He isn't doing anything. He's just looking at it.

AMOND BAKER (22) walks in without knocking, reading a BlackBerry.

AMOND

Tobias is on his way up. He says he's got something on the twenty thousand. And my mother called me three times this morning to ask if Harmony "reconsidered overnight," which, no, because I'm not a psychic.

Marc closes the laptop a half second too slowly.

Amond stops walking.

AMOND (CONT'D)

What was that?

MARC

What was what?

AMOND

You closed that like I caught you looking at porn.

MARC

I was looking at security footage.

AMOND

(coming around the desk)

Of what?

MARC

Amond—

Amond flips the laptop open. The frozen frame: Esther in scarlet, lit by gate floodlights, her face caught in that stricken, beautiful instant.

Amond stares at it. Then at Marc. Then back at the screen.

AMOND

Is that Esther Smilley?

MARC

(beat)

She came to the gate. Last night. In red. She handed the guard the invitation, looked at something in the booth, and left.

AMOND

I read Bernadette's column. The whole city read it.

(beat)

Why are you looking at it at one-thirty in the afternoon with the door closed?

MARC

(too casually)

Security review.

AMOND

Of one frame.

MARC

It's a very good frame.

Amond sits down on the edge of the desk and looks at his best friend.

AMOND

Marc.

MARC

What.

AMOND

That woman's family has hated your family since before either of our parents were born. Her father would sell his own kidney to see yours go under. And every time she shows up at that gate, three hundred people with telephoto lenses write about it.

(beat)

And we have a body in a park, a war with Silas on a Friday clock, and your sister sleeping at police headquarters to find you.

MARC

I know.

AMOND

So whatever this is—

MARC

It's nothing.

AMOND

It's a frozen picture of a woman on your laptop at one-thirty in the afternoon.

MARC

(quietly, looking at the screen)
She looked scared, Amond.

AMOND

(beat)
Of what?

MARC

I don't know. Something in that booth.

(beat)
And she came twice. Nobody comes to a gate twice if they don't want to go through it.

Amond looks at him for a long moment. Then he reaches over and closes the laptop, gently.

AMOND

You're going to get us all killed, you know that?

MARC

(a small smile)
Probably. But I'll look amazing doing it.

A KNOCK. TOBIAS OKAFOR (24) enters with his laptop under his arm and closes the door behind him with a quiet click.

TOBIAS

The twenty thousand.

MARC

Talk.

Tobias opens his laptop on the desk and turns it toward them. It shows a scanned bank deposit record and a list of serial numbers.

TOBIAS

Lamar Whitlock deposited two hundred hundred-dollar bills at the Cascade Community Credit Union on December tenth. New bills. Sequential serial numbers.
(beat)
Sequential serials mean they came from a single bank strap. Straight from a bank vault, never circulated.

AMOND

Can you trace the strap?

TOBIAS

I already did.
(tapping the screen)
That series was shipped by the Jacksonville branch of the Federal Reserve Bank of Atlanta on December sixth to one institution. Chatham Savings and Trust. A private bank.
(beat)
In Savannah.

Marc goes still.

MARC

Savannah.

TOBIAS

Somebody withdrew twenty thousand in fresh cash in Savannah and put it in Lamar Whitlock's hand in Atlanta four days later.

AMOND

Who banks at Chatham Savings and Trust?

TOBIAS

Old money. Shipping families. Port people. About eleven hundred accounts.

(beat)
I'm working on it. Private banks
don't love questions.

MARC
Then don't ask questions.

TOBIAS
(evenly)
I never do.

Marc picks up Alexander's pocket watch and turns it over
in his fingers.

MARC
(to himself)
Savannah.

AMOND
What?

MARC
Nothing.
(beat)
Everything in this family always
goes back to Savannah.

He winds the watch. It ticks.

CUT TO:

**12 INT. CITY HALL EAST – APD HEADQUARTERS – CHIEF'S
OFFICE – DAY**
Thursday, January 6, 2005 – 2:18 PM EST

Elxa at her desk with a legal pad in front of her, writing
fast. Jeremy sits across from her eating a sandwich from a
paper bag.

ELXA
Five people on the command staff.
Hughes, Tolbert, Kemp,
Washington, and Albright.
(writing)
Next Wednesday, I hold my first
full command-staff meeting.
Before it, I brief each of them
privately on the Piedmont
investigation. One-on-one. My
office. Door closed.

JEREMY

Okay.

ELXA

And I give each of them one
detail that nobody else gets.
Something fake. Something juicy.
(beat)
Then I watch Channel 8.

Jeremy stops chewing.

JEREMY

A canary trap.

ELXA

Arianna's idea.

JEREMY

(impressed)
That's cold.

ELXA

That's efficient.
(writing)
Tolbert gets "the victim had a
second phone." Kemp gets "we
found a partial print on the
coin." Washington gets "there's a
witness who saw a red car."
Albright gets "the victim's wife
hired a private investigator."

JEREMY

And Hughes?

Elxa looks up. She smiles a little, a dangerous smile
Jeremy has seen before.

ELXA

Hughes gets the best one.
(beat)
"The Chief believes the
Blackwater coin was a fake."

Jeremy sets down his sandwich.

JEREMY

Elx. The six crests. You said
nobody hears about the six
crests. Not the press, not the
FBI, not your family.

ELXA

I'm not telling him about the six crests. I'm telling him I "believe" it's a fake. No details. No proof. Just a theory.

(beat)

If it shows up on Channel 8, I know it's him. And the real killer reads that we're onto them, and maybe they get nervous.

JEREMY

Or they get careful.

ELXA

Nervous people make mistakes. Careful people make plans.

(beat)

I'd rather deal with the nervous ones.

Jeremy looks at his wife: the legal pad, the four gold stars on her collar, the circles under her eyes.

JEREMY

You know you're scary sometimes?

ELXA

(going back to her writing)

You married me.

JEREMY

I did.

ELXA

In front of God and the Atlanta Police Department.

JEREMY

(smiling, picking the sandwich back up)

Best decision of my life.

She doesn't look up. But she stops writing for just a second.

CUT TO:

13 INT. SAINT'S CAR WASH – WEST END – DAY

Thursday, January 6, 2005 – 2:47 PM EST

A busy hand car wash on Ralph David Abernathy Boulevard. Six bays. Young men in red polo shirts with soapy mitts and pressure hoses. Hip-hop blasting from a boombox: OutKast's "Ms. Jackson." A hand-painted sign reads "SAINT'S – WE DETAIL YOUR SINS AWAY."

In the glass-walled office above the bays, RASHAD "SAINT" MAYFIELD (23) sits with his feet on the desk, counting receipts, a toothpick in his mouth.

A knock. EARL "BIG E" TUGGLE (51) squeezes through the doorway: large, balding, gold chain, and a Falcons windbreaker straining at the buttons. He's grinning.

BIG E

Saint!

SAINT

(feet down, standing, a
genuine grin)

Big E! What's good, Unc?

They do a big, back-slapping hug. Big E pulls a thick white envelope from inside his windbreaker and sets it on the desk.

BIG E

First Thursday of the month. Like
clockwork.

SAINT

(tucking it into a
drawer without counting
it)

Like clockwork.

BIG E

(settling into a
folding chair that
complains)

Man. This week, though.

SAINT

Tell me about it.

BIG E

Lamar Whitlock. I knew Lamar
thirty years. We ran numbers
together on Pryor Street when we
were kids. Lamar used to sing in
the choir at Greater Cascade, and
he couldn't sing a lick. Tone
deaf. But loud.

(beat, sobering)

They're saying y'all did him.

SAINT

(evenly)

Who's saying?

BIG E

Everybody. The barbershop. The
church. The Chinese place next to
my store.

(beat)

Merriweather's boys came by my
shop yesterday. Just looking.
Looking at my windows. Looking at
my coin.

Saint's jaw tightens.

SAINT

They touch you?

BIG E

Naw. Just looked.

(leaning in, lowering
his voice)

Saint. Man to man. Y'all didn't
do Lamar. Did you?

SAINT

(looking him dead in
the eye)

Big E. Look at me.

(beat)

We don't do deacons.

Big E studies him. Then he nods and breathes out.

BIG E

Good. 'Cause I been paying y'all
four years, Saint. Four years,
not one problem. Nobody's robbed
my store, nobody's broke my
glass, nobody's put a hand on my
grandbabies.

(beat)
I sleep good with that coin on my
counter. I'd hate to stop.

SAINT
(standing, clapping him
on the shoulder)
You keep sleeping good, Unc. That
coin means you're ours. Nobody
touches what's ours.

BIG E
(heaving himself up)
Aight. Aight.
(at the door, turning)
And tell whoever's in charge,
tell HIM, the Southside's scared.
For real. Old heads like me
remember last summer. Nobody
wants that again.

SAINT
I'll tell him.

Big E waves and squeezes back out the door.

Saint watches through the glass as Big E crosses the lot
below, stopping to joke with the car wash boys, buying a
soda from the machine and laughing loud.

Saint opens the drawer and looks at the envelope. Then he
picks up the phone and dials.

SAINT (CONT'D)
(into phone)
Right Hand. It's Saint.
(beat)
Merriweather's people are walking
by our protected shops. Looking
at the coins in the windows.
(beat)
Yeah. I don't like it either.

He hangs up. Below, Big E's old Cadillac pulls out onto
the boulevard and disappears into traffic.

CUT TO:

14 INT. THE DOWAGER HOUSE — THE MORNING PARLOR — DAY
Thursday, January 6, 2005 — 3:14 PM EST

The yellow Creole parlor. The hundred photographs.
Afternoon sun through the tall shutters.

Simone sits in her favorite armchair with a cup of tea,
doing the New York Times crossword in ink.

Across from her, JOAN DONOHUE (66), in a camel pantsuit,
sits on the edge of the settee holding a cup she hasn't
touched.

JOAN
—and he got out of the car, and I
walked into the house, and I have
not spoken to him since.

SIMONE
(filling in a word)
Twenty-two hours.

JOAN
Twenty-two hours.

SIMONE
In forty-five years, what's your
record?

JOAN
(beat)
Four days. 1974. The Nixon
dinner.

SIMONE
(nodding, writing)
He deserved four days for that.

JOAN
He deserves longer for this.

Simone sets down her pen and takes off her reading
glasses.

SIMONE
Joan. Ask me what you came here
to ask me.

Joan holds her mother-in-law's gaze.

JOAN
Did Victor call the mayor about
Elxa?

SIMONE
(without hesitation)
Of course he did.

Joan closes her eyes.

SIMONE (CONT'D)
He's a Donohue, baby. When has a
Donohue ever let a door stay
closed when he had a key in his
pocket?

JOAN
(opening her eyes)
She earned that job, Mother
Simone.

SIMONE
I know she did.

JOAN
She would have gotten it anyway.

SIMONE
Probably.

JOAN
Then why—

SIMONE
Because "probably" is for people
who don't own the building.

Joan looks at her, startled. It's the same line Natasha
used on Monday, word for word, though Joan doesn't know
it.

SIMONE (CONT'D)
Where do you think my
granddaughter learned it?
(beat)
The question isn't whether he
called, Joan. The question is
whether Elxa ever finds out. If
she does, then yes, God help him.
That child will never forgive
him, and she'll be right not to.
(beat)
And if she doesn't, then the only
sin was getting caught. And he
hasn't been.

JOAN
(quietly)
You sound like him.

SIMONE
He sounds like me, baby. I was
here first.

Joan sets down her teacup.

JOAN
I spent twenty-four years on the
federal bench so that nobody in
this family could buy anything
that mattered. And my husband
bought our granddaughter's badge.

SIMONE
(gently)
Your husband paid for something
she already owned. That's a
different sin. Smaller. Stupider.
(beat)
Go home, Joan. Make him sleep in
the library for a week. Let him
think about his stupidity. And
then forgive him, because you
married him, and because Elxa
will need all of us when the
truth comes out.

JOAN
You think it will?

SIMONE
(putting her reading
glasses back on)
The truth always comes out in
this family, Joan. It just takes
the scenic route.

A knock at the parlor door. WINSTON leans in.

WINSTON
Madam. Miss Grace and Miss
Mallory have arrived. With...
(he searches for the
word)
...a great many jars.

SIMONE
(brightening)

Oh, good. Send them in. Joan,
stay. You'll enjoy this.

JOAN
(rising, smoothing her
jacket)
I should go—

SIMONE
Sit down. Your granddaughter is
about to try to sell me my own
recipes. You don't want to miss
that.

Joan, despite everything, sits back down. A reluctant
smile.

FADE OUT.

ACT FOUR**15 INT. THE DOWAGER HOUSE – THE MORNING PARLOR –
CONTINUOUS**

Thursday, January 6, 2005 – 3:21 PM EST

GRACE BULLOCK (20) and MALLORY OLSON (19) enter carrying two large wicker baskets between them. Grace is in jeans and a blazer, trying to look like an executive. Mallory is in a pencil skirt with a leather portfolio, already looking like one.

GRACE

Hi, Gorgeous! Hi, Grandma Joan!

JOAN

Hello, baby.

SIMONE

You're early.

MALLORY

You said three-thirty.

SIMONE

And it's three-twenty. Early. You get points for that.

MALLORY

(to Grace, under her
breath)

Told you.

They set the baskets on the coffee table and begin unpacking: dozens of small GLASS JARS with handwritten labels. Creams, balms, oils, a tiny vial of amber perfume. They arrange them in careful rows.

Simone watches them over her glasses, saying nothing. Joan sips her tea, amused.

GRACE

(nervous, rushing)

Okay. So. Gorgeous. So. We had a whole speech, but Mallory says I talk too fast when I'm nervous, so she's going to start—

MALLORY

—and Grace is going to do the emotional part.

GRACE

I'm VERY good at the emotional part.

SIMONE

I'm aware. I watched you sing last night. Half of Buckhead was blowing their noses.

MALLORY

(opening her portfolio,
all business)

Great-Grandma. Grace and Glory is a luxury beauty and lifestyle brand. Skincare, fragrance, cosmetics. Made for women of color, by women of color. We're targeting the premium market: department stores, spas, and high-end salons. Price point comparable to Chanel and Estée Lauder.

(turning a page)

The Black beauty market in the United States is worth an estimated seven and a half billion dollars a year, and almost none of the luxury brands in it are Black-owned. In five years, we project—

SIMONE

Mallory.

MALLORY

—we project first-year revenue of—

SIMONE

Mallory, baby.

Mallory stops.

SIMONE (CONT'D)

You can do arithmetic. I've never doubted that. Your grandfather could do arithmetic at three. Arithmetic runs in this family like high blood pressure.

(beat)

Tell me why.

Mallory opens her mouth, then closes it. She looks at Grace.

Grace takes a breath. She picks up one small jar, amber glass with a handwritten label: "TOUSSAINT ROSE BALM – No. 7."

GRACE

Because of these.

(beat)

Nana Ruby used to rub this on my hands every winter when I was little. My knuckles used to crack and bleed from the cold, and she'd sit me on the counter and rub it in and tell me it came from you. From before Granddaddy was born.

Simone's face doesn't change. But she sets down her crossword.

GRACE (CONT'D)

And Mallory found the old files in the DGH archives. From 1935. Toussaint Laboratories. Three thousand women, Gorgeous. Three thousand "Toussaint Ladies" in eleven states. Black women who went door to door selling your creams to other Black women, at a time when most department stores wouldn't let a Black woman try on a hat.

(beat)

Some of them bought houses with that money. Some of them sent kids to Spelman. There was a woman in Macon who paid off her whole farm.

(beat)

Mallory found her granddaughter. She's a pharmacist now. In Macon.

Simone is very still.

GRACE (CONT'D)

We don't want to sell face cream, Gorgeous. We want to bring the Toussaint Ladies back. In every beauty shop. Every church. Every college. Every girl who ever had cracked knuckles in January.

(beat)
And we want to do it with your
formulas. Because they're the
only ones that ever worked on
mine.

A long silence.

Joan sets down her teacup very quietly. Her eyes are wet.

Simone picks up the jar of Rose Balm No. 7. She unscrews
the lid and smells it. She closes her eyes.

SIMONE
(eyes closed)
Rose. Shea from Ghana. Beeswax
from a man in Thomasville named
Hollis who kept bees behind his
church. And a drop of vetiver,
because Alexander said everything
I made smelled "too much like a
lady," and I told him a lady was
exactly what it was supposed to
smell like.
(she opens her eyes)
You got the vetiver wrong.
There's too much.

MALLORY
(quickly, writing)
Too much vetiver.

SIMONE
(setting down the jar)
My formulas are seventy years
old. What makes you think you
deserve them?

GRACE
(beat)
We don't.

Simone raises an eyebrow. Mallory looks at Grace in alarm.

GRACE (CONT'D)
Nobody deserves them, Gorgeous.
Nobody in this family deserves
anything. That's what you always
say. You earn it or you lose it.
(beat)
So let us earn it.

Simone looks at her great-granddaughter for a long moment.
Then she turns to Joan.

SIMONE

She gets that from you.

JOAN

(wiping her eye)

She gets that from you, Mother
Simone.

SIMONE

(to Winston, who has
been standing silently
by the door)

Winston. The safe. The green one.

Winston bows and leaves. The girls exchange a look of
barely contained panic.

SIMONE (CONT'D)

When your great-grandfather and I
merged Toussaint Laboratories
into the family business in 1946,
the lawyers wanted the formulas.
They said everything had to
belong to the company. Alexander
agreed.

(beat)

I did not.

(beat)

The company licensed my formulas
for sixty years. It never owned
them. They're mine. They've
always been mine.

Winston returns carrying a worn, green, leather-bound BOOK
with a cracked spine and a brass clasp. He places it in
Simone's hands.

INSERT — THE COVER, stamped in faded gold: "TOUSSAINT —
FORMULARY — S.T. — 1931."

She holds it in her lap for a long moment, her
ninety-four-year-old hands resting on it.

SIMONE (CONT'D)

Vivienne Smilley tried to buy
this book from me in 1976.
Through a lawyer in Paris. She
offered two million dollars. It
was a great deal of money then.
(beat)

I sent back a jar of Rose Balm
with a note that said, "Not for
sale. But you look like you need
this."

Grace and Mallory BURST out laughing. Joan laughs too,
into her napkin.

SIMONE (CONT'D)
(not laughing, but her
eyes glitter)
She has hated me very
specifically ever since.

She holds the book out toward the girls. They both reach
for it at once, and Simone doesn't let go.

SIMONE (CONT'D)
One condition.

GRACE
Anything.

SIMONE
Vivienne Smilley's company sells
more luxury fragrance to Black
women than anybody in America.
Her daughter runs forty-eight
department stores. Her perfume is
on every counter at Neiman's.
(beat)
And they've just moved across the
street.

She lets go of the book. It's in Grace's hands now.

SIMONE (CONT'D)
Beat the Smilleys.

GRACE
(stunned, clutching the
book)
Yes, ma'am.

MALLORY
(overwhelmed)
Yes, ma'am.

SIMONE
(picking up her
crossword again, as if
nothing has happened)
And fix the vetiver.

CUT TO:

16 INT. SMILLEY TOWER — 70TH FLOOR — VIVIENNE'S OFFICE — DAY*Thursday, January 6, 2005 — 4:47 PM EST*

A white-and-silver office that smells faintly of her signature fragrance. Framed magazine covers from the 1970s: a stunning young Vivienne on the cover of *Ebony*, *Essence*, and a French perfume ad. A wall of fragrance bottles on backlit glass shelves.

VIVIENNE SMILLEY (49), who looks thirty-five, stands at a mood board pinning fabric swatches. DELPHINE SMILLEY-ASHE (25) lounges in a white leather chair, flipping through a trade magazine.

DELPHINE

—and the buyer at Rich's-Macy's says the Atlanta market is "sophisticated but loyal." Which means they buy what their mothers bought.

VIVIENNE

And what did their mothers buy?

DELPHINE

(tossing the magazine down)

Donohue Health and Beauty. Toussaint this, Toussaint that. The Rose Balm. Every church lady in Georgia has a jar in her purse.

Vivienne stops pinning. She turns slowly.

VIVIENNE

Toussaint.

DELPHINE

The old stuff. The company still licenses the name. It's grandmother cream. It's not luxury.

VIVIENNE

(quietly)

It could be.

DELPHINE

What?

VIVIENNE

Toussaint was luxury, Delphine.
Before either of us was born.
Before Smile. Before Chanel ever
bothered to make a foundation
darker than beige. Simone
Toussaint Donohue was the only
woman in America making luxury
skincare for Black women in 1935.
She sold it door to door, and
they paid for it in quarters, and
they worshipped her for it.

(beat)

If anyone ever brings those
original formulas back, the real
ones, not the watered-down
drugstore version, the Donohues
will own the Black luxury beauty
market in this country for the
next fifty years.

(beat)

And we will be the second-best
perfume on the counter.

DELPHINE

(sitting up)

Mother. Do you know where the
original formulas are?

VIVIENNE

(turning back to her
mood board)

In a green leather book in a
ninety-four-year-old woman's
safe.

(beat)

I offered her two million dollars
for it in 1976.

DELPHINE

What did she say?

Vivienne pins a swatch with a little more force than
necessary.

VIVIENNE

She sent me a jar of face cream.

Delphine laughs out loud. Vivienne does not.

VIVIENNE (CONT'D)
(coldly)
Find out who in that family is
working on beauty products,
Delphine. Quietly.
(beat)
Somebody always is.

CUT TO:

**17 INT. BULLOCK & ASSOCIATES, LLP – ROBERT'S OFFICE –
40TH FLOOR – DUSK**
Thursday, January 6, 2005 – 5:33 PM EST

Robert at his desk, reviewing a deposition transcript. The door is closed.

Camille enters without knocking and closes the door behind her. She's still in court clothes, a severe navy suit, and she's not smiling.

CAMILLE
She knew.

ROBERT
(not looking up)
Who knew what?

CAMILLE
Your wife. Last night. At the party.
(beat)
"You're not wearing perfume tonight, Camille. How considerate."

Robert sets down his pen.

ROBERT
She was being polite.

CAMILLE
Robert. I have cross-examined four hundred witnesses. I know the difference between a question and an accusation dressed up as a compliment.
(beat)
She held that air-kiss one second longer than she needed to. She was smelling me.

ROBERT

(beat)

And you weren't wearing anything.

CAMILLE

Which is exactly what someone
does when they know they've been
caught wearing something.

Robert leans back in his chair. For the first time, he
looks genuinely uneasy.

ROBERT

What do you want me to do?

CAMILLE

(sitting on the arm of
the sofa)

I don't know. That's the first
time in six years I've said that
to you.

(beat)

You could end it.

ROBERT

(quietly)

I could.

CAMILLE

Are you going to?

A long pause.

ROBERT

(beat)

No.

CAMILLE

(a sad, knowing smile)

No. You're not. You never end
anything, Robert. You just settle
it out of court.

She stands.

CAMILLE (CONT'D)

Silas Merriweather's man called
again today. Otis. He asked if
you'd consider representing Mr.
Merriweather in "an upcoming
civil matter."

ROBERT
What civil matter?

CAMILLE
He wouldn't say. But he asked me,
very politely, whether we'd ever
represented anybody connected to
the Blackwater Syndicate. Second
time in three days.

Robert's face goes very still.

ROBERT
What did you tell him?

CAMILLE
The same thing I told him
Tuesday. That we don't discuss
our clients with morticians.
(at the door)
But Robert, if Silas Merriweather
is asking, other people are too.
(beat)
And your wife is one of them.

She leaves.

Robert sits alone. He picks up his BlackBerry and scrolls
to a contact: "NATASHA – HOME." His thumb hovers over it.

He puts the phone face down on the desk.

FADE OUT.

ACT FIVE

**18 INT. THE BAKER HOME – 214 MAGNOLIA TERRACE – KITCHEN
– EVENING**

Thursday, January 6, 2005 – 6:05 PM EST

The warm Baker kitchen. A pot of spaghetti on the stove. Gloria at the counter, grating cheese a little too hard.

At the table, DR. CURTIS BAKER (50), who looks forty, sits in a cardigan with a dental journal and reading glasses. He's steady and decent, a man who has spent twenty-five years telling people to floss and meaning it.

Across from him, KIARA BAKER (15), in a Belmont Crest Academy sweatshirt, has a laptop open and AIM windows blinking, and is very clearly eavesdropping while pretending not to.

Amond stands in the doorway, still in his overcoat.

GLORIA
(grating)
"Not yet."

AMOND
That's what she said.

GLORIA
"Not yet," like I'm a bill she's
going to pay later.

CURTIS
(mildly, not looking
up)
Gloria.

GLORIA
Don't "Gloria" me, Curtis. I
talked to that girl in a powder
room last night. I apologized. We
laughed about hot sauce.

CURTIS
She likes hot sauce because of
me.

GLORIA
I KNOW she likes hot sauce
because of you, Curtis, that's
not the point!

KIARA
(not looking up from
the laptop)
The point is Harmony doesn't
trust y'all.

All three adults turn and look at her.

KIARA (CONT'D)
(still typing)
I'm just saying. You served her
papers at her job, Mama. That's,
like, extremely Belmont Crest.

GLORIA
Kiara Monique.

KIARA
I'm just SAYING.

Curtis hides a smile behind his journal.

AMOND
(tired)
She said we have to earn it. Show
up. For a while.

CURTIS
(setting down the
journal, taking off his
glasses)
That's fair, son.

GLORIA
Curtis!

CURTIS
It IS fair, Gloria. That girl
raised our granddaughter alone
for almost three years while our
son sent checks. I'd want him to
earn it too.

Amond takes that. It stings. He deserves it, and he knows
it.

GLORIA
(setting down the
grater)
So what do I do? Wait?

CURTIS
You're a principal, baby. You
tell children every day that
trust is earned. Practice what
you preach.

Gloria stares at her husband. Then she picks up the phone
on the wall.

GLORIA
I'm calling Stanley.

AMOND
Mama, don't—

GLORIA
(dialing)
I'm not withdrawing the petition,
Amond. Not until she agrees to
something. On paper. If she wants
us to earn it, then there'll be a
hearing, and a judge can tell us
all how.

AMOND
That's going to make it worse.

GLORIA
(into phone)
Stanley. Gloria Baker. Go ahead
and ask the court for a hearing
date.

Amond closes his eyes.

Kiara looks at her brother across the kitchen and silently
mouths: "EXTREMELY Belmont Crest."

CUT TO:

19 INT. BELLE RIVE — KITCHEN — EVENING
Thursday, January 6, 2005 — 6:31 PM EST

The kitchen is quiet tonight, with the leftovers of the
birthday put away. A pot of gumbo simmers on the stove.

NANA RUBY (66) stands at the counter chopping green
onions. NATASHA (43), still in her work clothes, sits at
the island with a glass of red wine, watching her.

NATASHA
Ruby.

NANA RUBY
(chopping)
Mm-hm.

NATASHA
Monday morning. When Robert
checked his phone at breakfast.
Grace says you made a face.

NANA RUBY
I've got one face, baby. God only
issued me the one.

NATASHA
That's what you told Grace.

NANA RUBY
Then that's what I'm telling you.

Natasha takes a sip of wine. She sets the glass down very
precisely.

NATASHA
Ruby. You changed my diapers.

NANA RUBY
(still chopping)
I did not. I came to this house
in 1980. You were nineteen and
pregnant with Elxa and you cried
at the sight of a raw chicken.

NATASHA
(despite herself, a
laugh)
I did not.

NANA RUBY
You did. Robert had to cook for
three weeks. He burned
everything. You lost eight
pounds.

NATASHA
(smiling, then not)
Ruby. I'm asking you as a woman.
Not as your employer.

Nana Ruby stops chopping. She sets down the knife and
wipes her hands on her apron. She turns to face Natasha.

NANA RUBY

Twenty-five years I've been in this house, Natasha. I've seen a lot of things. I've seen babies born and dogs die and your husband cry the night your daddy almost fired him in 1988.

(beat)

And I've learned one thing. When a man comes home in a different shirt than he left in, at seven o'clock at night, and says he spilled decaf...

(beat)

...you don't ask the housekeeper about the face she made.

NATASHA

(quietly)

What do I ask?

NANA RUBY

(going back to her onions)

You ask him where the first shirt went.

A long pause. Natasha looks into her wine.

NATASHA

(barely)

Thank you, Ruby.

NANA RUBY

(chopping)

I didn't say anything, baby. I'm making gumbo.

The back door opens. Grace and Mallory BURST in, glowing and breathless. Grace clutches the green leather book to her chest like a newborn.

GRACE

MAMA!

MALLORY

We GOT it!

NATASHA

(instantly bright, the hurt hidden)

Got what?

GRACE
(holding up the book)
The formulary! Gorgeous gave us
the book! The ORIGINAL! From
1931!

NANA RUBY
(turning, eyes wide)
The green book?

MALLORY
You know about the green book?

NANA RUBY
(drying her hands,
reverent)
Baby, every woman who ever worked
in the Donohue kitchens knows
about the green book. Miss Simone
kept it in her apron pocket until
1970. We thought it was a Bible.

GRACE
She said we had to beat the
Smilleys.

NATASHA
(raising her glass)
Then you'd better beat them,
baby.

Grace and Mallory squeal and hug. Nana Ruby hugs them
both.

Over their heads, Natasha looks through the window toward
the dark driveway, where Robert's car isn't parked yet.

CUT TO:

20 INT. HARMONY'S TOWNHOUSE – DINING ROOM – NIGHT
Thursday, January 6, 2005 – 7:34 PM EST

The little dining table is crowded with a family dinner:
fried chicken from Dee's Kitchen in foil containers,
collards, cornbread, and sweet tea in a plastic pitcher.

Harmony, Loretta, and Lyric in her booster seat. And at
the head of the table, still in his MARTA uniform and cap,
CALVIN DIVINE (51), who looks forty-one. He's a big,
soft-spoken, gentle man, a deacon and a union man, with
hands like baseball mitts.

At the far end of the table is an EMPTY CHAIR with a plate set in front of it. Nobody mentions it. It's always there.

CALVIN
(bowing his head)
Lord, bless this food and the
hands that bought it from Dolores
Whitfield.

HARMONY AND LORETTA
Amen.

LYRIC
Amen chicken!

They eat. Calvin is quiet. Loretta watches him.

LORETTA
Tell him, baby.

HARMONY
(beat)
Daddy. The DA read Dee's file
this morning. Before we even got
there. She's reopening it. Four
investigators, Monday. She
promised she won't stop.

Calvin chews slowly. He says nothing.

HARMONY (CONT'D)
Daddy?

CALVIN
(setting down his fork)
I heard you, Harmony.

HARMONY
You don't look happy.

CALVIN
I'm fifty-one years old. I've
driven the 71 bus down Cascade
Road for twenty-eight years. You
know how many promises I've heard
in twenty-eight years?
(beat)
Every politician in this city has
ridden my bus at election time.
Every one of them shook my hand
and promised.

LORETTA

She's not a politician, Calvin.

CALVIN

She won an election, didn't she?

A beat.

HARMONY

(quietly)

She broke a pen, Daddy.

CALVIN

She what?

HARMONY

She was so upset for us that she broke a pen under her desk and got ink all over her hand. And she didn't even notice until she went to shake mine.

(beat)

Politicians don't do that.

Calvin looks at his daughter for a long time. Then he looks at the empty chair at the end of the table.

CALVIN

(softly)

Your brother used to break pencils like that. When he was little. When he was trying hard not to cry.

The table goes quiet.

LYRIC

(pointing at the empty chair with a drumstick)

Uncle Dee's chair.

LORETTA

(gently)

That's right, baby.

LYRIC

Is he coming?

A long, terrible pause.

CALVIN

(finally, his voice steady)

I don't know, Lyric-bird.
(beat)
But somebody's looking.

He reaches over and squeezes Harmony's hand with his big one.

CALVIN (CONT'D)
Somebody's finally looking.

Harmony squeezes back, her eyes filling.

CUT TO:

21 INT. DONOHUE MANOR — THE LIBRARY — NIGHT

Thursday, January 6, 2005 — 8:07 PM EST

The twenty-thousand-book library. A fire. On the leather Chesterfield sofa, someone has laid out a pillow, a folded quilt, and a pair of men's pajamas, pressed.

Victor stands in the doorway in his overcoat, just home from the Tower, looking at the sofa.

Winston stands beside him with a perfectly neutral face.

VICTOR
Winston. What is that.

WINSTON
A bed, sir.

VICTOR
I can see it's a bed. Why is it in the library?

WINSTON
(carefully)
Mrs. Donohue's instructions, sir.
For one week.

VICTOR
(beat)
One week.

WINSTON
Seven nights, sir. She was quite specific. She said, and I quote, "The Chairman may think about his stupidity among the classics."

Victor stares at the pajamas.

VICTOR

Did my mother put her up to this?

WINSTON

(a long, loyal pause)

The fire's lit, sir. And I've
left the brandy.

Victor sighs. He takes off his overcoat and hands it to
Winston.

VICTOR

Is she upstairs?

WINSTON

Yes, sir. Reading. With the door
locked.

VICTOR

(sitting heavily on the
sofa beside the quilt)

Forty-five years, Winston.

WINSTON

Yes, sir.

VICTOR

Four days in 1974. That's the
record.

WINSTON

This would be seven, sir.

VICTOR

(beat)

I'm aware of the arithmetic,
Winston.

WINSTON

(bowing slightly)

Good night, sir.

He withdraws. Victor sits alone in the library. He picks
up the folded pajamas, looks at them, and sets them down.

He looks up at the ceiling, toward the bedroom above.

VICTOR

(to the ceiling,
quietly)

She'd have gotten it anyway,
Joan.

The fire crackles. The house says nothing back.
He pours himself a brandy.

CUT TO:

**22 INT. THE CUMMINGS ESTATE – 41 KINGSRIDGE DRIVE –
ARIANNA'S BEDROOM – NIGHT**

Thursday, January 6, 2005 – 8:42 PM EST

A grown woman's bedroom in her parents' mansion. It's elegant but still has traces of a girlhood: debate trophies, a Spelman pennant, and a framed photo of a teenage Arianna with Marc and Amond at the Magnolia Cotillion, all three of them fifteen and in braces.

Arianna sits on her bed in sweatpants and a Spelman T-shirt, her knees pulled to her chest, staring at nothing. Her briefcase sits unopened on the floor.

A soft knock. DR. YVETTE CUMMINGS (51) enters in a silk robe, carrying a tray with two cups of chamomile tea and a plate of ginger snaps.

YVETTE
Your father's asleep in front of
CNN. I made tea.

ARIANNA
(forcing a smile)
Thanks, Mama.

Yvette sets the tray down and sits on the edge of the bed. She's a cardiologist. She notices things.

YVETTE
You didn't eat dinner.

ARIANNA
I had a late lunch.

YVETTE
You had a granola bar at eleven.
Preston told your father. Your
father told me.

ARIANNA
(a small laugh)
Preston's a snitch.

YVETTE

Preston's worried about you. So
am I.

Arianna picks up a cup of tea. Her hands are steady now,
too steady, the way they get when she's holding something
down with enormous effort.

ARIANNA

I met a family today.

YVETTE

The Divine family.

ARIANNA

(startled)

How—

YVETTE

Loretta Divine is a charge nurse
at Grady. I've consulted on her
patients for fifteen years. She
called me at the hospital at noon
and asked if you were "a real
person or a politician."

ARIANNA

(barely)

What did you tell her?

YVETTE

I told her you're the most real
person I know.

Arianna sets the tea down. Her face crumples, just for a
second, and then she controls it.

YVETTE (CONT'D)

(gently)

Baby. What is it?

ARIANNA

I promised them I'd find him.

YVETTE

That's a good promise.

ARIANNA

It's been three years, Mama. He
walked out of a party on
Northside Drive at one forty-five
in the morning and nobody ever
saw him again.

YVETTE
(slowly)
Northside Drive.

A long, strange pause. Yvette looks at her daughter differently.

YVETTE (CONT'D)
That was the New Year's you came
home from the Hendersons' party.
On Northside.
(beat)
That was the New Year's you had
the flu.

Arianna goes completely still.

ARIANNA
(too quickly)
Everybody in Buckhead lives on
Northside, Mama.

YVETTE
(watching her)
Not everybody.

A long silence. Mother and daughter look at each other. Yvette doesn't know what she's looking at. Only that she's afraid of it.

YVETTE (CONT'D)
(carefully)
Can you find him? This boy?

Arianna looks at the photo on her dresser: herself, Marc, and Amond, fifteen years old in braces, laughing.

ARIANNA
(barely a whisper)
I know where to look.

Yvette doesn't understand. She holds her daughter's hand.

YVETTE
Then look, baby.
(beat)
And eat a ginger snap. You're too
thin.

Arianna laughs, a small wet sound, and takes a cookie. She eats it like medicine.

Yvette watches her, and her eyes stay troubled.

FADE OUT.

ACT SIX**23 INT. RAVENHURST – THE NURSERY – NIGHT**

Thursday, January 6, 2005 – 9:22 PM EST

The fairy-tale nursery with the silver crescent-moon night-light. Emma is asleep. Victoria is very much awake, standing in her canopy bed in footie pajamas and holding a hairbrush like a microphone.

A small radio on the dresser, which Bea uses for the classical station, has been turned by someone to V-103, Atlanta's R&B station. A familiar Hammond organ groove plays. It's Grace Bullock's "Crown Me."

VICTORIA
(singing along, loud
and off-key, with total
commitment)
"...CROWN ME, CROWN ME, PUT THE
GOLD ON MY HEAD..."

Esther appears in the doorway in her robe, drawn by the noise. She stops.

Victoria sees her and sings louder, performing now.

VICTORIA (CONT'D)
"...GOLD ON MY SOOOOUL, SO BABY,
CROWN MEEEE!"

She throws her head back on the last note, that big, whole-body gesture, exactly like a man on a security monitor twenty-four hours ago.

ESTHER
(quietly)
Victoria. Who changed Nanny Bea's
radio?

VICTORIA
(proudly)
Me!

ESTHER
How do you know this song?

VICTORIA
It's the funny man's sister!
Harmony said! It's on the TV and
the radio and Harmony's car!

Esther crosses to the radio and switches it off. Silence.

VICTORIA (CONT'D)
(outraged)
MOMMY.

ESTHER
(tucking her back in,
firmly)
Bedtime, Dividend.

VICTORIA
(yawning, defeated,
lying down)
I like that song.

ESTHER
I know, baby.

VICTORIA
(eyes closing)
Crown me...

She's asleep almost instantly, the way wild children are.

Esther stands over her daughter's bed in the moonlight glow. She looks at the silent radio, and then at the sleeping face.

She leans down and kisses Victoria's forehead.

ESTHER
(barely audible)
Somebody will, baby.

She straightens and walks out. At the door she pauses, goes back, and turns the radio dial back to the classical station.

CUT TO:

24 EXT. THE CUMMINGS ESTATE – THE GARDEN GAZEBO – NIGHT
Thursday, January 6, 2005 – 10:14 PM EST

A white Victorian gazebo at the bottom of a sloping lawn on Kingsridge Drive, strung with dead Christmas lights nobody has taken down. Frost on the grass. The great house glows up the hill.

Arianna sits on the gazebo bench in a long down coat over her sweatpants, holding a mug of tea gone cold.

Marc comes across the frozen lawn in a black overcoat, hands in his pockets. He walked through the woods from Sovereign Way, the way he has since they were children.

He climbs the gazebo steps and sits beside her. Close. Shoulder to shoulder.

For a long moment neither of them speaks. Their breath fogs.

ARIANNA

You walked through the woods.

MARC

I always walk through the woods.

ARIANNA

You'll get Lyme disease.

MARC

It's January. The ticks are in Florida with Uncle Alvin.

She almost laughs. She doesn't quite.

ARIANNA

(staring straight ahead)

Her mother came.

MARC

I know.

ARIANNA

She said, "You're younger than my son would be."

(beat)

Would be, Marc. She corrected herself. In the middle of a sentence. Like she's been correcting herself for three years.

Marc says nothing. He takes the cold mug out of her hands and holds her hands instead, between both of his.

ARIANNA (CONT'D)

And then Harmony pushed a flyer across my desk and said, "Everybody else stopped looking."

(beat)

And I said, "I won't stop."

MARC
(quietly)
I know. You told me.

ARIANNA
I PROMISED them.

MARC
Ari.

ARIANNA
(turning to him, low
and fierce)
I read the file this morning.
Detective Sams. Nine days. "Went
to Miami with a girl." Nobody
looked. Nobody looked, Marc,
because he was a barber from
Cascade and not a lawyer's kid
from Kingsridge.
(beat)
And now I'm the one who's
supposed to look. And I know. I
know exactly—

MARC
(sharp, soft)
Stop.

She stops.

MARC (CONT'D)
(very quietly)
Not out loud. Not even here. Not
even to me.

She stares at him. Her eyes are shining.

ARIANNA
(whispering)
Where is he, Marc?

A long silence. The dead Christmas lights sway in the
wind.

MARC
(beat)
Somewhere nobody will ever have
to see him the way you saw him.

ARIANNA
That's not an answer.

MARC

It's the only one I'm ever going
to give you.

She pulls her hands out of his.

ARIANNA

You can't protect me from this
forever.

MARC

Watch me.

ARIANNA

(her voice breaking)

I don't WANT you to protect me. I
want—

(she stops)

I don't know what I want. I want
to go back to New Year's Eve and
not get in the car.

MARC

(gently)

I know.

ARIANNA

I want to go back and call 911
instead of you.

That one lands. Marc absorbs it without flinching.

MARC

(beat)

I know that too.

ARIANNA

And I want Harmony Divine to stop
being so NICE to me. She held my
hand, Marc. With ink all over it.
She held my hand with both of
hers.

She finally breaks. It isn't sobbing, just a few hard,
silent tears she wipes away with the back of her wrist,
furious at them.

Marc puts his arm around her. She lets him. She leans her
head on his shoulder.

MARC

(quietly)

Listen to me. You made her a promise. Keep it. Reassign the case. Put your best investigator on it. Call her every two weeks. Look, Ari. Really look.

(beat)

Looking is not the same as finding. And you will never, ever be the one who finds.

ARIANNA

(barely)

That's monstrous.

MARC

(beat)

Maybe.

(beat)

But it's how you survive this. And you are going to survive this.

She doesn't answer. They sit in the cold, her head on his shoulder, the house glowing up the hill.

ARIANNA

(finally)

Go home. It's late. Your sister's probably watching the woods with binoculars.

MARC

My sister's at the office. My sister's always at the office.

ARIANNA

(sitting up, wiping her face)

Then go home before your mother sends Winston with a flashlight.

MARC

(standing, kissing the top of her head)

Eat something.

ARIANNA

I had a ginger snap.

MARC

Eat two.

He walks down the gazebo steps and back across the frozen lawn toward the dark woods.

Arianna watches him go. Then she looks up at the house.

In an upstairs window, a silhouette: Yvette, in her robe, watching. She's been watching the whole time.

The curtain falls closed.

CUT TO:

25 EXT. METROPOLITAN PARKWAY – "BIG E'S CHECK CASHING & PAYDAY LOANS" – NIGHT

Thursday, January 6, 2005 – 11:52 PM EST

Southside Atlanta. A cracked strip mall under sodium lights: a closed wig shop, a Chinese takeout with its grate down, and at the end a storefront with a glowing yellow sign:

BIG E'S CHECK CASHING & PAYDAY LOANS – "WE SAY YES."

The lights are still on inside.

26 INT. BIG E'S CHECK CASHING – CONTINUOUS

A small, grim office: bulletproof glass at the counter, a steel door to the back, fluorescent lights, a calendar from a Baptist church, and a framed photo of a big, laughing man with his grandkids.

Behind the glass, EARL "BIG E" TUGGLE (51), large, balding, with a gold chain and reading glasses on his nose, counts cash into a bank bag. The radio plays late-night quiet storm.

He zips the bag. He reaches under the counter, lifts out a heavy BLACK ONYX COIN, and turns it over in his thick fingers with a kind of respect. A crown above a wave. A protection coin. Blackwater's promise.

He sets it on the counter by the register, where it always sits.

A KNOCK on the front glass door.

Big E looks up. Beyond the glass, a figure stands under the sodium light: a tall man in a dark work jacket and a ball cap pulled low. His face is in shadow.

BIG E
(calling through the
glass)
We're closed, man! Come back at
nine!

The figure doesn't move. It raises one hand and presses something flat against the glass.

It's an ENVELOPE, fat with cash.

Big E squints at it. Greed and caution wrestle on his face. Greed wins. It usually does, at this hour.

He comes around the counter, unlocks the deadbolt, and opens the door six inches, the chain still on.

BIG E (CONT'D)
What you need, man? I'm closing
up.

The figure says nothing. It holds the envelope out at chest height.

Big E reaches for it through the gap.

A GLOVED HAND catches his wrist.

Big E's eyes go wide.

SMASH TO BLACK.

In the dark: a single, flat, muffled CRACK.

Silence.

Then, in the darkness, the sound of something small and heavy being set down on a glass counter.

Click.

FADE OUT.

END OF EPISODE #0004

NEXT ON BEYOND THE KINGDOM...

- At dawn on Metropolitan Parkway, JEREMY lifts a dead man's hand from the floor: a black onyx coin. He counts the crests. "Six."
- A woman in an FBI windbreaker ducks under the tape. SPECIAL AGENT KATE DOYLE, to ELXA: "Chief. This is a federal case now."
- At Dee's Kitchen, SILAS MERRIWEATHER walks through the front door for the first time in thirty years. MAMA DEE, behind the counter: "Friday, Silas."
- ARIANNA, alone in her car in the dark, sobbing into the phone: "She asked ME to find him, Marc. She asked ME."

FADE TO BLACK.